Ruth: Grace in the Dark

Judges 17–21 · Ruth 1–4

The big idea: When everyone did what was right in his own eyes, God was quietly at work. A Moabite widow took refuge under the wings of Israel's God, and Boaz, a redeemer who was a close relative, able to pay, and willing, made her his wife. Their great-grandson was King David.

Before you meet: Read

Judges 21:25 | Ruth 1:1–22 | Ruth 4:1–17

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever been treated as an outsider? What made you feel welcome?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"In those days there was no _____ in Israel. Everyone did what was right in his own _____." *(Judges 21:25)*

"And she _____ to come to the part of the field belonging to Boaz." *(Ruth 2:3)*

"Spread your wings over your servant, for you are a _____." *(Ruth 3:9)*

Discuss

1. Everyone did what was right in his own eyes. Where do you see that in our culture? Where do you see it in yourself? *Judges 21:25*

2. Naomi said the LORD had brought her back empty. Was she right? How does the rest of the story answer her? *Ruth 1:20–21; 4:14–17*

3. A redeemer had to be a close relative, able to pay, and willing to pay. How does Jesus fulfill each one? *Hebrews 2:14; 1 Peter 1:18–19; Galatians 4:4–5*

Memory verse

"For where you go I will go, and where you lodge I will lodge. Your people shall be my people, and your God my God."

Ruth 1:16

Pray

Confess the places where you do what is right in your own eyes. Thank God for his quiet providence in your story. Thank Jesus, your Redeemer, who became your brother and paid your price, and ask him to rule your heart as King.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 26

Ruth: Grace in the Dark

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Ruth 1:6–22 and 4:9–17 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (1 Samuel 8, 16, and 17).

Main points to land

1. When everyone did what was right in his own eyes, the weak were crushed. Judges ends crying out for a king who would do what is right in God's eyes (Judg. 21:25).
2. Ruth shows God's quiet providence and his welcome of outsiders. A Moabite widow takes refuge under the wings of Israel's God and becomes David's great-grandmother (Ruth 2:12; 4:17).
3. Boaz the kinsman-redeemer points to Jesus, who became our relative, paid with his own blood, and was willing to give everything (Hebrews 2:14; 1 Peter 1:18–19).

Core doctrine to teach

Election and Sovereign Grace

CORE DOCTRINE 13 OF 26 · GRACE ALONE

Salvation begins with God, not with us. Before the world began God chose a people to save, not because of anything good in them, but out of his own love. He calls outsiders like Ruth, a Moabite widow, into his family. Grace is undeserved, and it is the only reason anyone is saved. *Ruth 1:16; 2:10; Ephesians 1:4–5; 2:8–9; John 6:37*

Answer key (Observe)

1. king; eyes
2. happened
3. redeemer

Questions people will ask

Deuteronomy 23:3 says no Moabite may enter the assembly. How could Ruth be accepted?

The law shut out Moab as a nation that met Israel with curses (Deuteronomy 23:4). Ruth came the other way, leaving her gods and taking refuge under the LORD. The prophets promised that foreigners who hold fast to God would be welcomed (Isaiah 56:3–7). Ruth is an early sign that faith, not birth, brings people into God's family.

Closing prayer

Father, you did not abandon your people in their darkest days, and you quietly wrote a story of redemption through a Moabite widow and a kind farmer. Keep us from doing what is right in our own eyes. Help us live as people under your rule, not our own. Thank you for Jesus, our Redeemer and King, who became our brother and paid our price. Shelter us under your wings. Amen.